

TAME NOTIFICATIONS IMMEDIATELY

Most Android annoyance begins with notification permission. Apps ask early because they know users tap Allow. Do not. Allow notifications only for apps that deserve to interrupt you.

Messaging apps, banking apps, calendar, delivery apps, cab apps and security apps may need notifications. Shopping apps, games, wallpaper apps, video apps and food apps do not automatically deserve them. Promotions are not emergencies.

After setup, open Settings > Notifications > App notifications. Sort by recently installed or most frequent. Turn off anything noisy before it becomes part of your routine. This one step can make a new phone feel calmer for years.

from your personal number. These are not technical failures. They are setup failures.

Step-by-step: configure dual SIM properly

- Open Settings > Network and internet or Connections.
- Tap SIMs or SIM manager.
- Rename each SIM.
- Set default mobile data SIM.
- Set default calling SIM.
- Set default SMS SIM.
- Turn on Wi-Fi calling if your operator and phone support it.
- Test one outgoing call from each SIM.
- Send one SMS from the SIM linked to banking or UPI.
- Open your UPI app and complete mobile number verification only after SIM settings are correct.

Defaults decide daily behaviour

Android will ask which browser, SMS app, phone app, launcher, keyboard and assistant you want to use. These choices matter because defaults create habits. If your default browser is cluttered, every link becomes cluttered. If your default keyboard is uncomfortable, every message becomes friction. If your default SMS app buries OTPs, payments suffer.

Go to Settings > Apps > Default apps. Set your browser, phone app, SMS app, digital assistant and launcher deliberately. If the phone maker has its own browser full of notifications and shopping links, you are not obliged to use it. If the default keyboard lacks your preferred Indian language input, switch to one that works better for you.

Also configure autofill and password manager. This will become increasingly important as Android, Google accounts,

apps and passkeys become more deeply connected. A power user does not remember fifty weak passwords. A power user uses a password manager and protects it well.

Do not install everything on day one

The temptation is strong. New phone, clean storage, fast processor—why not install every app you have ever used? Because a clean phone is a rare chance to rebuild your digital life with taste.

Install in layers. First, install essentials: banking, UPI, WhatsApp, email, maps, browser, password manager, authenticator, cloud storage, office apps, cab apps and delivery apps. Then use the phone for a day. Add entertainment and shopping apps later. Add rarely used apps only when needed.

This approach gives you two advantages. First, fewer apps demand permissions at once. Second, you can spot battery drain, notification spam and performance issues more easily. If you install 90 apps on day one, you will never know which one caused the chaos.

Remove bloat without breaking things

Many Android phones sold in India include extra apps. Some are useful. Some are duplicates. Some are advertising pipelines wearing app icons. Do not angrily delete everything. Be surgical.

Open the app drawer. Identify apps you will never use. Try uninstalling them. If uninstall is not available, disable them where possible. Do not disable core system apps unless you know what they do. Keep essential manufacturer apps for updates, device care, warranty, camera features and service support.

Also check folders created by the manufacturer. Some “Tools” folders are useful. Some “Hot Apps” or “Recommendations” sections are best removed from the home screen immediately.

Your first-hour finishing checklist

Before declaring setup complete, run this final checklist.

Your Google account is correct. Your backup is on. Your screen lock is strong. Fingerprint works. Find Hub is enabled. Play Protect is on. Unknown app installs are blocked. Dual SIM defaults are correct. UPI verification works. WhatsApp is restored. Contacts are visible. Photos backup is configured according to your preference. Default browser, SMS app, phone app and keyboard are set. Promotional notifications are reduced. Unwanted apps are removed or disabled. Storage has plenty of free space. System update is checked. Play Store apps are updated.

Now, and only now, personalise the phone. Set the wallpaper. Arrange the home screen. Add widgets. Choose ringtones. Sign in to streaming apps. Install games. Make the phone yours.

The point is not to make Android complicated. The point is to make it intentional. A badly set up Android phone keeps asking for your attention. A well-set-up Android phone quietly gets out of your way. That is the first lesson of becoming an Android power user. **d**